

Transparency Sham

Why are the BCCI and IPL Governing Council shying away from disclosing beneficial ownership of the IPL teams?

On April 14, 2010, at 10:40:26 p.m., IPL Commissioner Lalit K. Modi sent an email from *lkm@iplt20.com* <*mailto:lkm@iplt20.com*> to Niranjan Shah, N. Srinivasan, Sanjay Jagdale, M.P. Pandove, I.S. Bindra, Arun Jaitley, Chirayu Amin, Rajiv Shukla, Sunil Gavaskar, Ravi Shastri, MAK Pataudi, Farooq Abdullah, all the franchisees and officials, including the CEO of IPL. In all, Modi addressed the mail to 55 people and marked copies to 21 people, including Sharad Pawar.

In his mail, Modi exhorts his colleagues and the franchise owners to enable the disclosure of beneficial owners of all the teams. Surprisingly, the bigwigs, including BCCI President Shashank Manohar, N. Srinivasan, Niranjan Shah and Leader of the Opposition in Rajya Sabha Arun Jaitley advised against full disclosure.

The contents of some of the mails presented below tell the untold story of the key members of the BCCI and how the IPL Governing Council (GC) prevented full disclosure.



Lalit K. Modi

April 14, 2010 at 10: 40 p.m.

Dear friends,

Propriety and fair play demand that **we should, as a public body, disclose ownership details along with names of directors of all franchises once again.**

Earlier, at the time of bidding, we only disclosed the names and shareholding.

If everyone is okay with this, we will issue the same right away. That way all doubts and aspersions being cast on the IPL franchisees and members of the GC will be appropriately rebutted. I hope you all agree with the same.

Warm regards

Lalit Modi

Chairman and Commissioner, IPL

Shashank Manohar



April 15, 9:17 a.m.

Dear Lalit,

The issue is complex and needs detailed deliberation, the legal implications need to be gone into and, hence, can be considered at the GC meeting

where all the documents and papers related to the bids are available.

Warm regards

Shashank

April 21: **Why Modi didn't disclose ownership pattern in three years** **Shashank Manohar**



Arun Jaitley

April 15, 9:39 a.m.

I endorse Shashank's proposal

Arun Jaitley



N. Srinivasan

April 15, 11:20 a.m.

I completely agree with the President.

Srinivasan



Niranjan Shah

April 15, 11:28 a.m.

I agree with the President's view.

Regards

Niranjan



Chirayu Amin

April 15, 11:39 a.m.

Let's go with President's views and discuss in GC.

Chirayu



Ravi Shastri

April 15, 8:44 p.m.

I agree with the President. If there are legal implications on the horizon, it's better to tread cautiously rather than being in a hurry. A GC meeting, sooner rather than later, is crucial and a must.

Ravi.

Interestingly, all of them have chosen to address their response only to council members even though Modi had written to all the participants and officials of the IPL. Other GC members Rajiv Shukla, I.S. Bindra, Farooq Abdullah and Sunil Gavaskar did not respond.

NOTE:

Those who were sent the mail include: Vijay Mallya, Amrit Thomas, Ritesh Bhatnagar, Vijay Rekhi, N. Srinivasan, R. Srinivasan, Raghu Rakesh Singh, Nikhil Meswani, Mukesh Ambani, Aditya Chellaram, Suresh Chellaram, Manoj Badale, Lachlan Murdoch, Santanu Chari, Gaurav Burman, Mohit Burman, Preity Zinta, Ness Wadia, Karan Paul, Srinivas Bommidala, Amrit Mathur, P.B. Vanchi, Jk, N. Krishnan, Jay Mehta, Shah Rukh Khan, Colleen Venning, Fraser Castellino, Arvinder Singh, Aditya Khanna, Venkat Reddy, Raj Kundra, Shilpa Shetty Gurunath, Nita Ambani, Ram Reddy, Sushil Jain, Sean Morris, Sid Mallya, Karuna, Abhijit Sarkar, Niranjan Shah, Shashank Manohar, Inderjit Bindra, Ravi Shastri, Sunil Gavaskar, MAK Pataudi, Chirayu Amin, Arun Jaitley, Rajiv Shukla, Farooq Abdullah, M.P. Pandove, Sanjay Jagdale. Those copied on the mail include Sharad Pawar, Radhika Moolraj, Viraf Mistry, Poorna Patel, Faisal Shariff, Laila Mallya, Sundar Raman, Gauri, Andrew Wildblood, John Loffhagen, Peter Griffiths, Graca Morgado, Michael Fordham, Catherine Simpson, Louise Anthony, Vandana Gupte, Utkarsh Prasanna Kannan, Kabir Mallya, Saloni, Paul Manning